

GENDER

Ashwini vs. Prakhar



BENDERS

What's Up With The Icons?



We took an image of our Desktop, complete with icons and all—and placed it as the background, and then hid the actual icons. Clicking on the “icons” therefore did not open any files or folders! Prakhar turned to us, a little confused. Upon a hint, he changed the desktop background, and realisation dawned: the icons had been hidden! Prakhar searched for how to get them back in **Display Properties > Desktop > Customize Desktop**. Not finding it there, he again right-clicked on the Desktop and checked the menu. He located “Arrange icons by” right at the top, and clicked “Show desktop icons”—there they were, all the icons, safe and sound!



Ashwini quickly realised we'd set up a trick task, and was a little unclear about what she was supposed to do. When clicking on the icons did not change anything on the screen, she immediately changed the desktop background. She came to a stall at this point: even when she did right-click on the screen and a menu popped up, she couldn't immediately discern the correct thing to do to bring the icons back. After some thought, she chose the “Arrange icons by” path and finished the task by clicking “Show desktop icons.” Well done, Ashwini—for time and for not needing a hint!

To analyse it a little, would a .xxx domain actually help reduce porn from proliferating? It probably wouldn't make a difference. Porn site operators will not relinquish their .com and .net domains in exchange for a .xxx domain; for them, having only a .xxx domain would mean easy censorship. They

would probably keep their old domain names and also register the new domains—meaning more money!

As regards the argument that .xxx would help authorities filter lewd material and help parents protect their children, it might be unfounded. Pornographic Web sites are everywhere, operated by

people in different countries. What worldwide law would force adult site operators to relegate themselves to a specialised domain? It seems a near-impossible task.

BEYOND SEARCH

Google Unveils New Tools

Google on 17 May unveiled new products that could turn search into more of a group activity. One of these is Google Co-Op Beta (google.com/coop), where users can save links or label Web pages and make their choices available to others. As an example of how Co-Op might be used, a researcher could tag certain Web pages related to, say, nanotechnology. Anyone who subscribes to that list would be shown the researcher's selections at the top of their search under, say, “developments,” whenever they enter a search term such as “nanotubes.”

Google has already arranged with partners to create pre-selected content, such as health and city guides, and restaurant and movie information. “Going forward, the broader online community will begin building out new topic areas,” Google said in a statement.

Then there's Google Notebook (www.google.com/notebook)—a program that lets users keep text, links, or images from search results

on a scratch pad. The Notebook can be accessed from any computer, and, if the user wants, it can be shared.

Google Trends (www.google.com/trends) lets users see how popular a specific search term is for a given period of time, as a trend line measures billions of searches.

Google also showed off Google Desktop 4 Beta (desktop.google.com), an upgrade to Google Desktop Search, which permits Google Gadgets—little programs—to be more easily downloaded and installed. The Gadgets can show weather reports without users having to open a browser, and can provide games, music, and news. Desktop 4 Beta also can track your searches if you want it to, and then create a personalised home page related to those searches.

Google has said it has “hundreds” of Gadgets ready for download. Developers will be able to create and share Gadgets of their own.

Some observers see Google's new releases as part of the trend towards social networking and user-created material on the Web. “Google is making it easier to create user-generated content,” said Jennifer Simpson, a research associate at the Yankee Group. “Yahoo, Microsoft, and AOL are also all beginning to release user-generated applications or services that have a social context, in search and elsewhere. For search, it's part of a big thrust to increase the value of results to consumers.”

Nintendo Wii

The much-anticipated Nintendo Wii gaming console will soon be hitting the market. Word is that it will be priced “under \$200.” What's special about it? Well, if you're playing tennis, you use the controller as a racquet! The main controller acts like a gamepad when turned on its side. The distance between the controller and console can be ten metres. Four controllers can be used

simultaneously, meaning four players can be part of a game! Two sensors help the console pinpoint the position, orientation and acceleration, in 3D, of the Wii remote. The controller has a speaker and a rumble motor! An expansion slot on the remote allows you to plug in add-ons such as the much-vaunted Nunchuk controller—a classic controller for games that require gamepad functionality.

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